

Reading for Understanding and Meaning

1. 'Lahoris are unaware of the dangers of high cholesterol'. Why would an outsider think that this statement is true? What does the writer see as the 'reality' behind this statement? (Paragraph 1)

- **The Outsider's View:** An outsider would think this is true because Lahoris eat huge amounts of meat that is cooked in very large quantities of oil and butter.
- **The Reality:** The writer explains that the reality is not a lack of knowledge, but that meat is so important and essential to Lahori culture and cooking that it simply cannot be replaced.

2. Why do you think the family elders still cook with *ghee*? Why do they say the younger generation no longer wants to do so? What do you think is the real reason why the younger generation does not want to cook with *ghee*? (Paragraph 2)

- **Why Elders Use It:** They use it because they consider it "asli ghee" (real or pure clarified butter) and part of their tradition.
- **Elders' View on Youth:** The elders claim the younger generation avoids it because they are following "unnatural fads" or temporary trends.
- **The Real Reason:** The text suggests the real reason is health-related, as the writer describes the grease as being "artery-blocking".

3. Which words in the second paragraph could be applied to the 'meaty dishes' mentioned in the third paragraph, to which the writer ascribes his bypass surgery?

- The words from the second paragraph are "**artery-blocking**".

4. Why would *karahi gosht* appeal to a gourmet rather than a gourmand? (Paragraph 4)

- A gourmet (someone who appreciates high-quality food) would enjoy it because it is prepared with fresh ingredients like ginger, coriander, and spices.
- The writer also notes that it takes a "**connoisseur**" (an expert) to choose the best quality of meat from the display, showing that the dish is about quality and skill rather than just eating a lot.

5. Explain the tactile appeal of *paayey* to the writer. (Paragraph 5)

- The "tactile" (touch-based) appeal is that the soup is so thick and "**glutinous**" that it makes your "**fingers stick to each other**" after you have eaten it.

6. Why is the Lahoris' favourite fish more difficult to obtain than it used to be? (Paragraph 6)

- The fish (*rahu*) is harder to find because of **industrial pollution** in the river.

- Additionally, it has been crowded out since the **introduction of Chinese carp** into the Ravi river a few years ago.

7. Why do you think Lahore's Food Street has been such a success? (Paragraph 7)

- It is successful because it is **blocked to traffic** every evening, which allows people to walk around safely and freely.
- It also offers a "**wide array of traditional dishes**" from well-known restaurants all in one place, making it easy for people to choose exactly what they want to eat.